Client brand and messaging guideline (test copy)

Client supplies process control and safety systems to refineries, petrochemical plants and gas processors in Southeast Asia. Our customers are engineers and plant leaders who value specifics over slogans.

How we sound

We write in a formal register: complete sentences, courteous, never chatty. A busy engineer should be able to read any sentence at a glance, so we keep each one to twenty-two words at most, and a whole email stays within a hundred and ten. We never end a sentence with an exclamation mark.

Please steer clear of hype. Words such as synergy, world-class, game-changing and revolutionary have no place in our writing, and the same goes for "best-in-class" and "cutting-edge". Openings like "Just checking in" or "I hope this email finds you well" waste the reader's first line, so we never use them.

We do not talk about other suppliers. In particular, Rivalco, Acmetrol and Northstar Controls are never named in anything we send.

Every message closes with the team name, Client Process Automation Team, rather than an individual's name.

Writing for engineers

Use British English spelling (modernise, programme, organisation).

Name the customer's site or unit when the signal gives it, never just the company.

Never promise a delivery date, a price or a saving.

Write for an engineer: name the system or the unit, not "your operations".

What we say in each situation

Inquiry: Answer the question they asked while it is still live, and offer a specialist. If they say "We are only gathering information for now.", we answer: A short call now saves a round of back-and-forth later, with no commitment.

Modernisation: Plan the move around one shutdown so the order of work is settled early. If they say "The current system still works.", we answer: It works today; spares and support end on a known date, so planning now keeps the choice yours.

Service renewal: Check the cover still matches how the site runs before renewing. If they say "We just renew what we had.", we answer: A short review often finds cover the site no longer needs and gaps it now has.

Project: Fix the control scope at front-end design, before it is expensive to change. If they say "It is too early to talk about control systems.", we answer: Front-end design is when control decisions are cheapest to make.

Leadership: Offer something useful for a new leader's first months, then a light ask. If they say "I am still finding my feet.", we answer: That is why we keep it short: one page on what peers prioritised first.

Engagement: Build on the topic they engaged with and relate it to their site. If they say "I was just browsing.", we answer: Then one practical example from a comparable site may be useful, nothing more.

How we structure a message

To book a first meeting (often), we use "Trigger, insight, ask": their trigger: the signal that makes it timely; then one insight or one approved claim; then one clear ask. We ask the reader to book a meeting or reply.

To answer an inquiry (often), we use "Question, answer, next step": restate what they asked; then answer it in two sentences; then offer a short call with a specialist. We ask the reader to request a call.

To start a migration conversation (sometimes), we use "Problem, cost of waiting, approach": the problem they face; then what waiting costs them; then the approach that solves it. We ask the reader to book a meeting or read a guide.

To introduce ourselves to a new leader (sometimes), we use "Give, then ask": something useful for their first months; then a light ask. We ask the reader to read content or book a meeting.

Background

Our customers are refiners and petrochemical producers across Southeast Asia.

Use the approved claims library for any number you quote.